

Instructions: You must show all of your work to receive a credit for a correct answer.

Problem 1. (10 points) The prices of a security follow a geometric Brownian motion with drift parameter $\mu = 0.05$ and volatility parameter $\sigma = 0.4$. The security's present price is 200. A new investment that is being marketed costs 20; after 2 year the investment will pay 25 if $S(2) < 180$, will pay x if $S(2) > 210$, and will pay 0 otherwise. The nominal interest rate is 6%, continuously compounded.

(a) What must be the value of x if this new investment is not to give rise to an arbitrage?

$$(\gamma - \sigma^2/2)t = (0.06 - 0.08) \times 2 = -0.04, \quad \sigma\sqrt{t} = 0.4 \times \sqrt{2} = 0.5656$$

Let W be the normal random variable with mean -0.04 and standard deviation 0.5656 . We then have.

$$20 = (25 P(S(2) < 180) + x P(S(2) > 210)) e^{-0.06 \times 2}$$

$$e^{0.12} 20 = 25 P(W < \log(\frac{180}{200})) + x P(W > \log(\frac{210}{200}))$$

$$e^{0.12} 20 = 25 P(Z < \frac{\log(0.9) + 0.04}{0.5656}) + x P(Z > \frac{\log(1.05) + 0.04}{0.5656})$$

$$e^{0.12} 20 = 25 \Phi(-0.1157) + x (1 - \Phi(0.1572))$$

$$x = \frac{20e^{0.12} - 25\Phi(-0.1157)}{1 - \Phi(0.1572)} \approx 25.6$$

(b) What is the probability that $S(1) > 180$?

$$\mu t = 0.05 \times 1 = 0.05, \quad \sigma\sqrt{t} = 0.4 \times 1 = 0.4.$$

Let W be the normal random variable with mean 0.05 and standard deviation 0.4 .

$$\begin{aligned} P\{S(1) > 180\} &= P(W > \log(\frac{180}{200})) \\ &= P(Z > \frac{\log(0.9) - 0.05}{0.4}) \\ &= 1 - \Phi(-0.2304) \\ &\approx 0.5911 \end{aligned}$$